

THE UNMASKED JOURNAL

For Women Discovering Their ADHD

By Daniel Tesfamariam

You're not broken. You're neurodivergent.

YOUR DIAGNOSIS IS VALID

Even if you were diagnosed late.

Even if people say 'but you don't look ADHD.'

Even if you got straight A's (by exhausting yourself).

Even if you've been masking for decades.

Even if you still doubt it some days.

Your struggle was real. Your diagnosis explains it.

You are not lazy. You are not 'too much.'

You have a brain that works differently.

And this journal is for YOU.

ADHD IN WOMEN

Why we get missed, misdiagnosed, or diagnosed late:

- Internalized symptoms (anxiety, depression, shame)
- Masking (appearing 'fine' while internally drowning)
- Perfectionism as compensation
- People-pleasing to avoid rejection
- Emotional dysregulation labeled as 'hormonal'
- Daydreaming instead of hyperactivity
- Chronic exhaustion from trying so hard
- Messy but hiding it from others
- Starting projects, never finishing
- Time blindness that looks like 'not caring'
- Sensory overwhelm mistaken for being 'too sensitive'

Which ones resonate with me (circle or highlight):

Day 1

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 2

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 3

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 4

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 5

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 6

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 7

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 8

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 9

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 10

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 11

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 12

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 13

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 14

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 15

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 16

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 17

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 18

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 19

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 20

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 21

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 22

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 23

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 24

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 25

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 26

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 27

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 28

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 29

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 30

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 31

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 32

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 33

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 34

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 35

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 36

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 37

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 38

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 39

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 40

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 41

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 42

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 43

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 44

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 45

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 46

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 47

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 48

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 49

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 50

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 51

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 52

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 53

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 54

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 55

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 56

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 57

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 58

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 59

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

Day 60

Date: _____

Energy: 1 2 3 4 5

Today my ADHD showed up as:

What I'm proud of despite ADHD:

One thing I'm letting go of:

Self-compassion:

Tomorrow's ONE priority:

UNMASKING REFLECTION 1

Who am I without the mask?

The mask I wore was:

I masked by:

It cost me:

Without the mask, I am actually:

What I need others to know:

UNMASKING REFLECTION 2

The roles I played to hide my ADHD:

The 'perfect student' who actually:

The 'reliable friend' who actually:

The 'organized one' who actually:

The 'easygoing girl' who actually:

Who I really am underneath:

UNMASKING REFLECTION 3

Releasing the mask - one layer at a time:

One mask I'm ready to release:

What scares me about unmasking:

What excites me about being authentic:

People I feel safe unmasking with:

My unmasking goal this month:

GRIEF FOR THE YEARS OF NOT KNOWING

It's okay to grieve what could have been.

What might have been different if I'd known sooner:

What I want to say to my younger self:

What I'm choosing to believe now:

MY ADHD SUPERPOWERS

ADHD isn't all struggle. Claim your strengths:

- ☐ Creativity/out-of-box thinking
- ☐ Hyperfocus on passions
- ☐ Empathy and emotional depth
- ☐ Resilience (we've survived so much!)
- ☐ Energy and enthusiasm
- ☐ Pattern recognition
- ☐ Crisis management skills
- ☐ Humor and quick wit
- ☐ Passion and intensity
- ☐ Big-picture thinking

My personal superpowers:

ACCOMMODATIONS I DESERVE

You are allowed to need support. That's not weakness.

- ☐ Written instructions instead of verbal
- ☐ Flexible deadlines when possible
- ☐ Body doubling for task initiation
- ☐ Visual reminders and alarms
- ☐ Noise-canceling headphones
- ☐ Movement breaks
- ☐ Shorter meetings with agendas
- ☐ Permission to fidget
- ☐ Reduced clutter environment
- ☐ Understanding during hormonal shifts

Accommodations I will ask for:

MY NEURODIVERGENT COMMUNITY

You are not alone. Find your people.

People who understand:

Name: _____ How they support me: _____

Name: _____ How they support me: _____

Name: _____ How they support me: _____

Name: _____ How they support me: _____

Name: _____ How they support me: _____

Online communities I follow:

Books/podcasts that help:

You are not too much. You are exactly enough.